

Syllabus: MA 511

Linear Algebra and its Applications, Summer 2026

Dr. Mahesh Sunkula

Basic Information

Instructor: Dr. Mahesh Sunkula; Office: MATH 842; E-Mail: msunkula@purdue.edu.

Lecture Times: MTWRF 9:50 AM - 10:50 AM, WTHR 172.

Office Hours: Mon, Wed, Fri 11:15 AM - 12:15 PM, MATH 842 & Via [Zoom](#)

Course Content

Text Book – Linear Algebra and its Applications, 4th Edition, by Gilbert Strang. We will cover most of the first 6 chapters of the book.

Brightspace – This is where you will find recorded lecture videos, lecture notes, and course documents. Announcements will also be posted here.

Gradescope – Written HW problems must be submitted through Gradescope. Access Gradescope via the Brightspace link for more information.

Piazza – Discussion forum and online homework help.

Grades

Course grades will be determined from your overall score computed as follows:

Homework	40%
Exam 1	30%
Exam 2	30%

Course letter grade cutoffs will certainly be at least as generous as the following:

A+(97), A(93), A-(90), B+(87), B(83), B-(80), C+(77), C(73), C-(70), D+(67), D(60). For each of these grades, it's possible that at the end of the semester a somewhat lower percentage will be enough to get that grade. (In other words, the lowest percentage to get, for example, an A could be lower but will not be higher than 93%.)

Homework

There will be a total of six homework assignments, with due dates listed on the course schedule. Note that the HW is by 11:59 PM (West Lafayette Time) on the specified date. All assignments must be submitted on Gradescope. Late submissions will not be accepted unless prior approval is granted with appropriate documentation.

Examinations

There will be two exams. Dates, times & locations of the exams are listed below:

Exam	Date	Time	Location
Exam 1	July 10	9:50am - 10:50am	WTHR 172
Exam 2	August 5	9:50am - 10:50am	WTHR 172

Grade Appeals

Students who wish to appeal their homework and exam grade on a problem should submit a regrade request through Gradescope. Regrade requests will only be accepted for 3 days after the grades are returned.

Calculators

Calculators or other mathematical software may be used on homework, but it is important that you not become too reliant on the calculators. You must be able to do simple manipulations by hand, and calculators will not be allowed for use on the midterms and final exam

Collaboration

Collaboration on the Homework is both allowed and encouraged. Discussion with peers is a common and effective way to distill and reinforce your knowledge. Make sure that your work reflects your own understanding. Copying another person's work constitutes academic dishonesty and undermines your own learning progress. Collaboration with peers or people outside the class is prohibited on Midterm and the Final Exam. It will be considered Academic Dishonesty and result in a zero grade on the exam.

Make-up Policy

Except in unusual circumstances (illness, family emergency, etc., documented), no make-ups will be given on midterm or the final. If you need a make-up exam, you should email Dr. Sunkula in advance, as soon as you can.

Academic Adjustments for Students with Disabilities

Purdue University strives to make learning experiences accessible to all participants. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are welcome to let your instructors know so that we can discuss options. You are also encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: drc@purdue.edu or by phone: 765-494-1247. If you have been certified by the Disability Resource Center (DRC) as eligible for accommodations, you should contact your recitation TA to discuss your accommodations as soon as possible. You should send your Course Accessibility Letter to your recitation TA and also to the professor; here are instructions for how to do this www.purdue.edu/drc/students/course-accessibility-letter.php

Nondiscrimination Statement

Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community which recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her own potential. In pursuit of its goal of academic excellence, the University seeks to develop and nurture diversity. The University believes that diversity among its many members strengthens the institution, stimulates creativity, promotes the exchange of ideas, and enriches campus life. More details are available on our course Brightspace table of contents, under University Policies.

CAPS Information

Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) at (765)494-6995 and www.purdue.edu/caps during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS office, room 224 of the Purdue University Student Health Center (PUSH) during business hours.

Commercial Note Taking in Classes

Notes taken in class are generally considered to be “derivative works” of the instructor’s presentations and materials, and they are thus subject to the instructor’s copyright in such presentations and materials. No individual is permitted to sell or otherwise barter notes, either to other students or to any commercial concern, for a course without the express written permission of the course instructor. See University Senate Document 03-9, April 19, 2004.

Academic Dishonesty

Academic integrity is one of the highest values that Purdue University holds. Individuals are encouraged to alert university officials to potential breaches of this value by either emailing integrity@purdue.edu or by calling 765-494-8778. While information may be submitted anonymously, the more information that is submitted provides the greatest opportunity for the university to investigate the concern.

Purdue prohibits “dishonesty in connection with any University activity. Cheating, plagiarism, or knowingly furnishing false information to the University are examples of dishonesty.” [Part 5, Section III-B-2-a, University Regulations] Furthermore, the University Senate has stipulated that “the commitment of acts of cheating, lying, and deceit in any of their diverse forms (such as the use of substitutes for taking examinations, the use of illegal cribs, plagiarism, and copying during examinations) is dishonest and must not be tolerated. Moreover, knowingly to aid and abet, directly or indirectly, other parties in committing dishonest acts is in itself dishonest.” [University Senate Document 72-18, December 15, 1972]. For more details about the Purdue Policy on academic dishonesty see: <http://www.purdue.edu/odos/academic-integrity/>

Course and Instructor Evaluations

During the last two weeks of the semester, you will be provided an opportunity to evaluate this course and your instructor(s) through online course evaluations. On Monday of the 14th week of classes, you will receive an official email from evaluation administrators with a link to the online site. You will have two weeks to complete this evaluation. Your participation in this evaluation is an integral part of this course. Your feedback is vital to improving education at Purdue University. We strongly urge you to participate in the evaluation system.

Other Issues

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances beyond the instructor's control. To get information about changes in this course please check Brightspace regularly.

Disclaimer

This syllabus is subject to change. Updates will be posted on Brightspace.